



Servers

Entry level Servers

Acer Altos G520

Specs: Xeon 2.8GHz, E7320 Chipset, 8 GB maximum memory support, 512 MB RAM, 10,000 rpm SCSI 80 GB HDD and Ultra 320 SCSI Adapter

Our Verdict: The Acer Altos G520 with the Xeon processor and Intel E7230 chipset is upwardly scalable and offers excellent headroom in terms of adding an additional processor. The motherboard supports around 8GB of memory—good from the upgradeability point of view. PCI-Express offers enough bandwidth for devices such

as Gigabit Ethernet, which are rather restricted on today's PCI bus.

Overall, the Altos G520 is an excellent server machine as it offers the right kind of balance in terms of power and upgradeability.



Runner-up:
HP ProLiant ML-110

Speakers

5.1 Speaker Systems

Creative Inspire 57

Specs: 35 Hz to 20 KHz frequency response, Satellite 7W, Centre 21 W, Subwoofer 30 W, Support for Dolby Digital, DTS, Dolby ProLogic and CMSS.

Our Verdict: The Inspire 5700D from Creative has a comprehensive feature set, the most important being the presence of Digital/Analogue inputs and a full-featured remote.

Performance is inspiring, with clear treble and deep bass.

Runner-up:
Creative MegaWorks 550



TV Tuners

Internal TV Tuner Cards

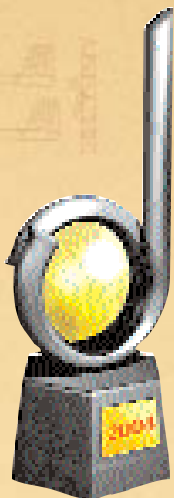
Compro VideoMate TV Gold Plus

Specs: MPEG 1/2 Capture supported, 720x576 maximum resolution supported and Nicam Stereo

Our Verdict: Compro's Videomate TV Gold Plus is an excellent TV tuner card characterised by good quality signal reception. The card can tune to most channels perfectly without any human intervention. The bundled software is excellent and pro-

vides an easy interface for most users.

Runner-up:
Mercury TV Tuner Card



Creative Desktop Theatre DTT2500D

Specs: Satellites 7 W, 21 W Centre, 20 W Subwoofer, support for Dolby Digital

Evolution: The Desktop Theatre DTT2500 is very similar to its present-day incarnation—the Inspire 5700D. The biggest difference is that compliance to

various audio standards has increased. This results in true convergence of conventional audio with the PC, and so, DVDs can be played with great results on a PC. Another factor is the price: the DTT2500 was then priced at Rs 33,000. The present-day Inspire 5700D costs Rs 24,000!